

Deer velvet in S. Korea (3rd quarter of 2024)

Reported on 10th of Oct 2024

1 Quarantine statistics of deer velvet from major export countries¹⁸

1.1 Dried velvet

Dried velvet (kg)								
Country	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024 (~Sep)
New Zealand	61,815	78,410	44,535	37,811	24,369	39,655	47,958	13,416
China	61,972	74,117	69,716	77,990	72,634	89,569	74,318	61,536
Russia	50,989	42,132	46,450	54,042	55,986	43,896	29,109	24,508
Hong Kong	11,293	15,402	17,828	13,701	22,372	23,835	12,597	4,347
Kazakhstan	1,081	1,270	701	2,354	1,428	2,097	1,095	
Total	187,198	211,410	179,782	185,931	176,842	199,086	165,095	103,815

1.2 Frozen velvet

Frozen velvet (kg)								
Country	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024 (~Sep)
New Zealand	64,809	81,365	99,113	77,477	91,874	116,584	116,292	58,873
China	68	6	10		2		2.6	419.3
Russia		3						
Total	64,900	81,380	99,124	77,477	91,877	116,591	116,295	59,292

1.3 Rolling year

Dried velvet (kg)			Frozen velvet (kg)		
Country	Oct 2022 - Sep 2023	Oct 2023 - Sep 2024	Country	Oct 2022 - Sep 2023	Oct 2023 - Sep 2024
New Zealand	48,688	17,966	New Zealand	125,331	70,073
China	89,733	81,792	China	1.1	420.8*

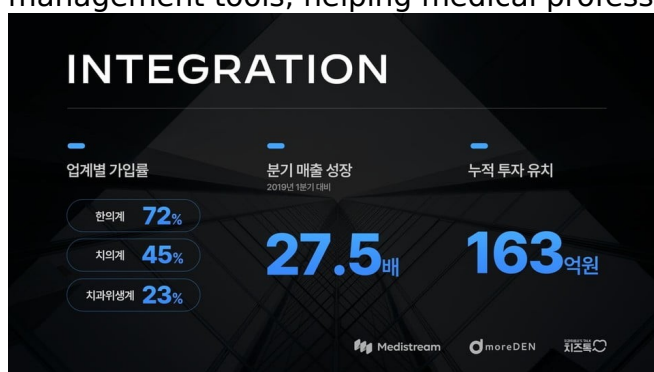
Russia	47,386	44,329	Russia		
Hong Kong	8,917	8,427	Hong Kong		
Kazakhstan	915	751	Kazakhstan		
Australia	20	11	Australia		0.2
USA	2.4	1.3	USA		
Others	0.1	0.2	Others	4.7	0.4
Total	195,660	153,277	Total	125,337	70,494

*400 kg frozen velvet from China cleared Korea customs in February of 2024

2 Korean news

2.1 Korean MedTech Startup Raises \$231 Million

MedTech startup **Integration** secured 231 billion won in Series C funding, the largest for a medical community-based startup. Investors include KDB Bank and Korea Investment & Securities. Integration operates platforms for healthcare professionals, including "**MediStream**" for **traditional Korean medicine doctors, with a 78% sign-up rate**. Their platforms support doctors, dentists, and hygienists by offering services such as e-learning, e-commerce, and management tools, helping medical professionals focus on patient care.



Hankyung, 2024-04-02¹

2.2 A2 milk market in Korea heats up as Yonsei and Seoul milk enter the competition

The A2 milk market in Korea, previously dominated by Yuhan Care, is seeing increased competition with the entry of Yonsei Dairy and Seoul Milk Cooperative. A2 milk, known for potentially causing less digestive discomfort, contains only A2 protein and lacks the potentially inflammatory A1 protein found in regular milk. Yuhan Care, which had an exclusive contract with Australia's A2 Milk Company, has seen significant growth in sales of their A2 milk product despite overall declines in white milk consumption. Yonsei Dairy and Seoul Milk are leveraging their dedicated farms to produce A2 milk domestically. Seoul Milk has announced plans to convert all of its milk production to A2 milk by 2030. Despite the increased competition, Yuhan Care remains positive, viewing the market expansion as an opportunity to increase awareness of A2 milk. The industry is watching to see if this competition will lead to a larger market share battle or create a new growth opportunity for the dairy sector in Korea.

¹ <https://www.hankyung.com/article/202404024861i>

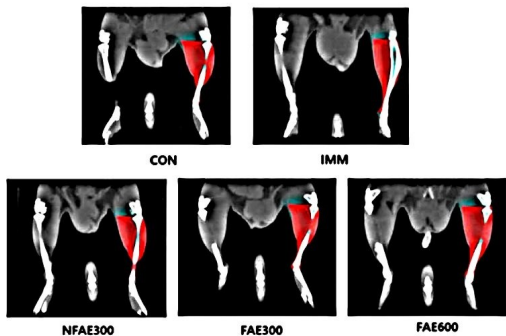


Green Economy News, 2024-04-23²

(The above two articles from Q2 were added for context regarding recent activities and other articles in this Q3 report.)

2.3 Fermented deer velvet gains scientific backing in Korea by BioCare

Successful proof of the muscle enhancement effects of fermented deer velvet extracts. A research team from Yonsei University's Department of Life Sciences, led by Professor Hwang Jae-gwan, in collaboration with **BioCare**, has demonstrated these effects. Their research has been published in the journal "Food Science and Biotechnology" which SCI (Science Citation Index) tier. The study found that the **fermented deer antler extracts improved muscle strength**, exercise performance, and muscle recovery. Bacillus subtilis was used for the fermentation. The team plans further studies to explore additional immune functions of the extracts.



Dong-A Ilbo, 2024-07-04³

2.4 Severe floods in Yeongdong claim over 300 deer and devastate farms

A significant flood in Yeongdong, North Chungcheong Province, where 300mm of rain caused severe damage, particularly to a deer farm. Over 300 deer drowned or went missing as a result of the flooding, which led to a 1-meter water level rise in the farm area. The local deer farming community suffered major losses, with deer swept away by strong currents. The flooding also caused significant damage to nearby agricultural lands and homes. Despite efforts to protect the deer, many farmers were unable to prevent the tragedy.



The Korea Deer Times, 2024-07-10

² <https://www.greened.kr/news/articleView.html?idxno=313493>

³ <https://www.donga.com/news/lt/article/all/20240704/125771407/1>

2.5 Traditional deer velvet medicine increased by KRW 597 billion

According to the 2022 Korean Traditional Medicine Yearbook, the **total production value of deer velvet as a traditional medicine material, was the highest at 59.7 billion won**. The import countries for traditional medicine materials were China, Russia, and New Zealand in that order.

The production value of ginseng, another traditional medicine material, decreased compared to the previous year. The number of ginseng farms decreased by 4.2% to 18,236, and the cultivated area increased by 1.4% to 14,734 hectares.

The total production value of traditional medicine materials was 243 billion won, up 19.2% from the previous year. The export value of traditional medicine materials was 12.1 billion won, down 35.7% from the previous year. The number of traditional medicine material manufacturers decreased by 8.7% to 340.



The Korea Deer Times, 2024-07-10

2.6 Biodot award supports natural product research

The 2024 Biodot Award, held during the Korean Society of Applied Biological Chemistry's conference, recognized two outstanding Ph.D. students for their work on natural products. Winners included researchers in immune responses and obesity treatment from natural materials, and advancements in plant metabolite optimization. Biodot, known for supplying deer velvet and other natural ingredients since 2010, continues to support young researchers while expanding into OEM manufacturing.



Health KyungHyang, 2024-07-15⁴

2.7 Jeong Kwan Jang leads global herbal supplement sales

KGC's Jeong Kwan Jang brand ranked first in the global herbal supplement market, as per Euromonitor's 2023 report. With a 3.9% share and sales of \$1.16 billion, the brand outperformed competitors in a \$29.88 billion market. Products like ginseng and deer velvet have contributed to its success, with a focus on expanding internationally through collaborations with platforms like Costco and Amazon.



Maeil Marketing News, 2024-07-18⁵

⁴ <https://www.k-health.com/news/articleView.html?idxno=73342>

⁵ <https://www.maeilmarketing.com/news/articleView.html?idxno=10675>

2.8 Yuhan Care implements voluntary retirement as health supplement industry faces market stagnation

Yuhan Care, a health supplement company in Korea, is implementing a voluntary retirement program for its employees until the end of July. The company states this decision is aimed at "sustainable management and a second leap forward."

The health supplement industry in Korea is facing challenges due to a saturated market, increased overseas direct purchases, and a decline in wellness trends post-pandemic. The domestic health supplement market, which had been growing steadily since 2019, has entered a period of stagnation, with **only 0.9% growth in 2023 compared to the previous year**.

Yuhan Care's sales, which had increased significantly during the COVID-19 period, **decreased by 23.2% in 2023 compared to 2022**. Industry insiders cite market saturation, advertising restrictions, and decreased consumer interest in wellness as contributing factors to the current difficulties faced by the health supplement sector in Korea.



Green Economy News, 2024-07-18⁶

2.9 Jeollabuk-do implements foot-and-mouth disease vaccination for deer

Jeollabuk-do Province is conducting a comprehensive **foot-and-mouth disease vaccination** program for **1,452 deer across 93 farms**. The vaccinations, costing 43 million won annually, will be completed by August using specialized veterinarian teams. This initiative, unique to Jeollabuk-do since 2011, aims to maintain the region's FMD-free status. The timing accommodates deer breeding and antler harvesting cycles. Officials stress the importance of thorough vaccination and adherence to quarantine rules to prevent potential outbreaks. Seoul News Comms, 2024-07-25⁷

2.10 Heavy rain ruins the farm

On July 18, 2024, heavy rain with 193mm of precipitation hit Pyeongtaek, South Korea, causing significant damage to the Jeil Deer Farm. The farm lost one adult elk, three fawn deer, and nine black goats due to drowning and hypothermia. The farm's feed was also submerged in water, resulting in a total property damage of 45 million won.

⁶ <https://www.greened.kr/news/articleView.html?idxno=316627>

⁷ <http://www.snakorea.com/news/articleView.html?idxno=828670>



The Korea Deer Times, 2024-07-25

2.11 National deer velvet competition showcases high-quality velvet production

The 32nd National Elite Deer Selection Competition was held in Asan, South Chungcheong Province, featuring **57 velvet antlers from 42 deer farms across South Korea**. The event, organized by the Korea Deer Association, aims to improve deer breeding and increase farmers' income. Ahn Jong-ho from Chungbuk Deer Farm in Cheongju won the grand prize with his **elk antlers weighing 27.15kg**. Ahn attributed his success to balanced nutrition and stress-free rearing environments. The competition highlights the industry's efforts to promote high-quality domestic velvet antler production despite challenges such as rising feed costs.

The winner Ahn Jong-ho, who runs a deer farm in Cheongju-si, raises 250 deer and runs a company specializing in deer velvet processing called **Mom En Young Bio**. Health foods made of deer are currently sold at large discount stores such as E-Mart, Lotte Mart, and Nonghyup Hanaro Mart, and they are also **exporting to Vietnam, Australia, Singapore, and Malaysia** to help raise K-food awareness.



The Farmers Newspaper, 2025-07-26⁸

2.12 DINZ's new chairman appointed

Deer Industry New Zealand (DINZ) appointed Paddy Boyd as the new chairman of the board. Boyd, who is a lifelong member of the NZDFA and won the 2014 Deer Industry Award, has been playing a pivotal role in the board since 2023. Rhys Griffiths, the temporary CEO of DINZ, is expected to become the permanent CEO. Griffiths visited Korea in 2022 and toured a deer farm operated by then-chairman Jeong Hwan-dae.

⁸ <https://www.nongmin.com/article/20240724500565>



The Korea Deer Times, 2024-08-10

2.13 New Zealand deer semen export to Korea

Two advertisement of New Zealand deer semen sales on the Korea Deer Times as below.



<New Zealand Deer Semen Supply Guide for 2024> Advantages of New Zealand Deer Semen

- Improved efficiency of deer breeding due to prevention of inbreeding
- Safety from biosecurity
- Maximizing improvement effects through systematic genetic verification

2020 New Zealand semen

- Elk: 4 kinds (NZ)
- Storm, Tucson, Big Wok, Seafire

2024 New Zealand semen

- Elk: 3 kinds (NZ)
- Red deer: 2 kinds (NZ)
- 1 that won the competition (Korean, Elk)



<New Zealand Deer Genetics NZ - Import/Sales of New Zealand Deer Semen>

New Zealand's Premier deer genetics company,
Exclusive Korean Distribution Agreement for Deer Genetics NZ

- With over 65 years of experience in the New Zealand and international deer industry
- Exported deer semen, embryos, and live deer worldwide for 25 years
- Offers consulting services to the global deer industry with its extensive knowledge in deer genetics
- Selected and exported the best deer semen to Korea in 2024 after visiting local deer farms in Korea in 2023

The Korea Deer Times, 2024-08-10

2.14 Korea's first proof of safety..."KGC Chunnok Growing" for growing up kids

Jeong Kwan Jang, Korea's top health supplement brand, announced that their product, "Cheon Nok Growing," is becoming popular due to the "Gold Kids" trend. Made with premium SAT-grade New Zealand deer velvet, 6-year-old red ginseng, and a blend of natural ingredients, it supports children's growth. Rigorous eight-step quality control and over 30 years of deer velvet research back its safety and effectiveness. The product also features a kid-friendly green grape flavour and is part of a promotional event for new customers.



Maeil Ilbo, 2024-08-13⁹

2.15 KGC CheonNok sales 477 times over 10 years

South Korean ginseng company KGC's premium deer antler brand, Cheon Nok, has seen its sales soar 477 times in the past decade, reaching over 600 billion won. Launched in 2014, **Chunnok's cumulative sales exceeded 615.1 billion won until July 2024**. Annual sales, which were around 200 million won at the time of its release, grew 477 times to 84.2 billion won in 2023. The brand, which exclusively uses the highest grade (SAT) of deer antlers from New Zealand, has become a hit among middle-aged and older adults, with sales doubling around major holidays such as Chuseok. KGC, which boasts 125 years of research know-how, holds eight patents related to deer antlers and continues to expand its product range to cater to different life stages and situations, solidifying its position as the top player in the deer antler market.



한국인삼공사 실적 추이			
(단위: 억원, 별도기준)			
연도	2021	2022	2023
매출액	12,928	13,060	12,234
영업이익	1,164	875	811
당기순이익	863	748	816

출처: 전자공시시스템

Money S, 2024-09-02¹⁰

2.16 New Zealand 2024 F&B Showcase with Prime Minister Luxon's

New Zealand 2024 F&B Showcase Opens: New Zealand and South Korea are enhancing economic cooperation through the New Zealand 2024 Food & Beverage (F&B) Showcase held in Seoul. The event, organized by New Zealand Trade and Industry (NZTE), featured leading food and beverage brands and included a Memorandum of Understanding (MOU) signing between eight companies from both countries.

Prime Minister Luxon's Remarks: Prime Minister Christopher Luxon expressed delight in showcasing New Zealand's premium food products and strengthening ties with South Korea, emphasizing the quality of New Zealand's offerings enjoyed globally.

Deer velvet: Alpine Deer connects New Zealand deer products with consumers around the world, exporting venison, pet food and traditional herbal products. In Korea, Alpine Deer is the exclusive supplier of deer velvet raw materials used in Yuhan Care and nutraceutical products.

Event Highlights: The showcase featured 11 brands, including dairy, seafood, and wine, with special guest speakers Chef Roland Hinni and sommelier Kim Joo-Yong discussing food pairings. A Kapa Haka performance and a dinner featuring

⁹ <https://www.m-i.kr/news/articleView.html?idxno=1149749>
¹⁰ <https://www.moneys.co.kr/article/2024090210280098502>

New Zealand cuisine were also part of the festivities, attended by over 120 guests.

Trade Significance: In 2023, New Zealand exported NZD 1.19 billion worth of food and beverages to South Korea, making it a crucial trading partner. Wine exports have notably increased, marking it as the fastest-growing sector in this trade relationship.



Economic Review, 2024-09-05¹¹

2.17 Yuhan Care highlights deer velvet at NZ F&B showcase

Yuhan Care showcased its deer velvet products at the New Zealand F&B Showcase, the only Korean company to do so. The event, attended by New Zealand Prime Minister Christopher Luxon, highlighted collaborations between New Zealand and Korea. Yuhan introduced products like NewOrigin Deer velvet tonics and the newly developed HENKIV®, made from New Zealand's premium Super A-grade deer velvet. Yuhan's innovative enzyme-extraction method, recognized by the Korean FDA, was emphasized as a major breakthrough in enhancing immunity. Various cultural and business exchange programs also took place at the event.



Medipana, 2024-09-06¹²

2.18 Driving the young men into the battlefield...and Putin asks "eternal life & young"

Russian President Vladimir Putin's reported order for scientists to research methods to combat aging and potentially achieve "eternal life."

The directive, allegedly proposed by Putin's ally Mikhail Kovalchuk, instructs research institutes to investigate solutions for age-related issues such as

¹¹ <https://www.econovill.com/news/articleView.html?idxno=665965>

¹² https://www.medipana.com/article/view.php?news_idx=331058&sch_cate=1

cognitive decline, cell aging, and immune system deterioration. The order has faced criticism from scientists due to its timing during the Ukraine conflict and the significant financial burden of such research. The article also touches on speculation about Putin's health and his interest in unconventional health practices, while noting that the average life expectancy for Russian men is 67, significantly lower than Putin's current age of 71.

Rumours have been made that Putin acts supernatural and superstitious to seek youth and vitality. Typical **examples are that Putin drinks blood from the cut horns of a Siberian red deer or enjoys a bath with that blood.** In Russia, people who take baths with deer antler blood believe that the blood strengthens the immune system, prevents aging, and is especially good for men's energy. However, there is no scientific evidence yet that deer's soft antlers or their blood have therapeutic properties.



Newsis, 2024-09-06¹³

¹³ https://www.newsis.com/view/NISX20240906_0002878068

3 News related with product launching

3.1 JM Global Group 'Cheonmyeongsam Myeongin Jiryeok Chimhyanghwan'

Brand <Product name>	Cheonmyeongsam < Myeongin Jiryeok Chimhyanghwan >		
Company/Manufacturer	JM Global Group / Fine Natural		
Volume and type	225g (3.75gx60 balls)	Price in KRW	398,000
Product category	Processed foods	Other ingredients	Honey, herbal extracts
Deer velvet %	Not stated	Origin of velvet	New Zealand

Cheonmyeongsam from JM Global Group, has launched its first product, Myeongin Jiryeok Chimhyanghwan, with a special 77% discount promotion. (KRW 398,000 to KRW 89,000)

This supplement is targeted at those in need of an energy boost, including middle-aged adults, office workers with chronic fatigue, and students requiring stamina management. Key ingredients include high-quality New Zealand deer velvet combined with a unique formula of Korean herbs, known as MMC-5 and H-Royal 10.

The product is available for purchase at a discounted price on the brand's official website and is currently a top seller.



Se Gye Ilbo, 2024-07-16¹⁴

Appendix I. Spreadsheets are supplied separately

Import statistics. Korean import statistics for deer velvet.xlsx	Biosecurity pass recording not HS Code based trade records by export country . Source is Animal and Plant Quarantine Agency (농림축산검역본부 ¹⁵)
Food imports list. Korean food imports list for deer velvet.xlsx	Number of trade recording by food importers and products they imported. No volume or price of each trade but counting trade events. No data for imports for pharmaceutical purpose. Source is Imported Food Information Maru website (수입식품정보마루 ¹⁶)

¹⁴ <https://www.segye.com/newsView/20240716505742>

¹⁵ <http://eminwon.qia.go.kr/statistics/> (품목-국가별 수출입현황)

Food products.
[Deer velvet food
products in
Korea.xlsx](#)

Accumulated food product list over recent years. Based on various **news article** about product launching mostly supplied originally by the brand owner as a press release activity.

*To access previous reports please access [this online folder](#)